

The GNU operating system kernel (the central part of an operating system that performs memory and process management), called the GNU Hurd, was continuously delayed, but most of the remaining objectives of GNU had been achieved by 1991. With the release of the Linux kernel along with its source code by Linus Torvalds under the GNU General Public License (GPL) in 1992, the remaining GNU tools were modified to run on Linux and the initial objectives of GNU were considered complete. A brief naming controversy ensued that continues even today wherein the open source community is divided on whether to call it Linux or GNU/Linux.

Through all this, the software community also witnessed the development of FreeBSD and NetBSD (Berkeley Software Distributions) as open source operating systems. This culminated in OpenBSD, released in 1995. It's development continues even today and is noted for its versatility and portability.

Since 1993, numerous operating systems based on GNU, Linux and other open source software have been released. The most popular among this was most probably Debian GNU/Linux.

In the later 1990s, some of the open source software that remained popular include the Apache web server that



Richard Stallman,
the founder of GNU



Linus Torvalds, the
creator of the Linux
Kernel. He is a legend
in the open source
software community



Ubuntu is a popular GNU/Linux distribution